

PALM & GRACE

Honouring Lives. Preserving Legacies.

PHASE 1 CONTENT, EXPERIENCE & EMOTIONAL DIRECTION

Developer Working Packet • Revised September 2026

A digital sanctuary where a life is not reduced to dates, but remembered through story, image, voice and the people who carry it forward.

The Palm & Grace logo and formal brand assets will be supplied separately.

1. Creative North Star: The Palm & Grace Experience

Palm & Grace should feel less like a memorial website and more like entering a beautifully prepared room of remembrance. It should be quiet, personal, considered and unmistakably centred on one life. The person is always the centre of the experience. The design exists to hold their story, not compete with it.

Palm & Grace should feel cinematic, but never theatrical.

Cinematic design here means intimacy, pacing, atmosphere and emotional depth. It may use large portraiture, elegant typography, restrained motion, soft transitions, considered composition, subtle depth and generous negative space. It must not use grief as spectacle. The emotional weight should come from the person: their face, their words, their photographs, their relationships and the memories people share.

The visitor may arrive grieving, emotionally tired, distracted, older, or using a phone while preparing for or reflecting after a service. The interface should therefore feel intuitive and unhurried. Important information should be easy to find without forcing the visitor through complex navigation.

The intended feeling

- Warm, graceful and deeply human.
- Pastoral and comforting without assuming a visitor's religion or beliefs.
- Premium and cinematic without becoming showy or luxurious for its own sake.
- Emotionally safe: the site invites feeling but never tells a person how to grieve.
- Personal rather than institutional or technological.
- Accessible, calm and comfortable on mobile devices.

2. Emotional Architecture of a Memorial

A Palm & Grace memorial should unfold with the emotional rhythm of a short, quiet film rather than a collection of website modules. The recommended journey is:

ARRIVAL → RECOGNITION → STORY → CONNECTION → REMEMBRANCE → REFLECTION

Arrival

The first screen should establish presence before information. Where suitable, use a strong portrait or meaningful photograph, the person's name, dates and one restrained memorial line. Avoid cluttering this moment with multiple buttons, menus or service details.

Recognition

Allow the visitor a moment to see the person and understand whose space they have entered. A gentle cue may invite them to continue, but the experience should not rush them.

Story

The Life Story should unfold in readable sections with photographs placed where they add meaning. Long text should never become an intimidating wall. Typography, spacing and image rhythm should make reading feel intimate.

Connection

Memories from family and friends demonstrate the person through many perspectives. This is where the memorial becomes communal rather than merely biographical.

Remembrance

Galleries, video, service details and recordings preserve moments and provide practical access without interrupting the emotional narrative.

Reflection

The memorial should end intentionally rather than simply reach a footer. Consider returning to a portrait, a family-selected line, the person's name and dates, and a quiet invitation to remember or share.

A page may end, but remembrance does not need to.

3. Grief-Sensitive Language Standard

Language is part of the care experience. Palm & Grace should never prescribe emotion, explain away a death, assume spiritual beliefs or imply that grief follows a timetable. It should acknowledge loss while making room for love, memory, complexity and individual belief.

Use language that invites

- "Take a moment to remember."
- "Share a memory of Jonathan."
- "Stories shared by those who knew her."
- "The moments that made a life."
- "A life remembered with love."
- "Thank you for sharing this memory. Your words have been received with care."

Avoid language that instructs or assumes

- Avoid telling visitors to "celebrate rather than mourn".
- Avoid "they are in a better place" unless the family specifically chooses such wording.
- Avoid assumptions about heaven, angels, reunion, faith or an afterlife.
- Avoid euphemisms that obscure meaning when clarity is needed.
- Avoid clinical, database or transactional language in the public experience.

Public language: preferred vs operational

Public-facing language	Keep in administration layer
Life Story	Biography record
Share a Memory	Submit content
Memories Shared	User submissions
Remembering [Name]	Deceased profile
Service Details	Event data
Photo Memories / Gallery	Media assets
Thank you for sharing this memory	Submission successful
Explore a Memorial	Search records

4. Brand & Marketing Position

Palm & Grace should not market grief. It should communicate the value of preservation, remembrance and thoughtful digital storytelling. Families should never feel that their vulnerability is being used as a sales device.

The strongest brand proposition is preservation: photographs, stories, voices and memories often become scattered across phones, social media, printed programmes and family conversations. Palm & Grace gives them a lasting, beautifully considered home.

A funeral service lasts a day. A life story deserves somewhere to remain.

This line may be explored as campaign or website copy, but it should be tested in context and never used in a way that diminishes the importance of a funeral or other mourning traditions.

Marketing hierarchy

- First establish trust, meaning and emotional safety.
- Then show what the experience preserves and makes possible.
- Only after that explain features, packages or commercial details.
- Avoid urgency tactics, countdowns, aggressive calls to action or language that pressures bereaved families.
- Let beauty and clarity communicate quality rather than repeatedly calling the service “premium”.

5. Homepage Content Direction

Hero

Honouring Lives. Preserving Legacies.

Every life leaves a story worth holding close. Palm & Grace creates beautiful digital spaces where families and friends can remember, reflect and preserve the photographs, stories and memories that made a life uniquely theirs.

Primary action: Explore a Memorial

Secondary action: Discover Palm & Grace

Purpose

Remembrance deserves a place of its own. A place where photographs, stories, voices and memories can live together with dignity, long after a service has ended.

Palm & Grace creates thoughtfully designed memorial spaces that help families honour the people they love and preserve their stories for those who knew them, and for generations still to come.

Possible transition copy

More than dates. More than photographs. A life, remembered in the details.

What the homepage should not feel like

Do not lead with feature grids, technical explanations, QR codes or dashboard screenshots. The homepage should first make the visitor understand why Palm & Grace exists. Product capability can follow once emotional trust is established.

6. Phase 1 Public Experience

- Premium public website with a cinematic, emotionally restrained opening experience.
- Individual memorials with unique shareable URLs.
- Three memorial design directions: Male, Female and Child. These should differ through composition, typography and art direction, not stereotyped colour coding.
- Life Story with thoughtful long-form presentation.
- Photo and video galleries integrated into the story.
- Service information including date, time, venue and viewing/livestream details.
- Moderated memories and tributes. Public submissions never publish automatically in Phase 1.
- External livestream or recording embeds supplied by a family or videographer.
- QR capability for each memorial as a useful access feature, not the centre of the product.
- Secure administration for memorial creation, media management, moderation and publishing.
- Mobile-first performance and accessible navigation.

7. Our Story: About Palm & Grace

The public-facing About page should be titled “Our Story”. It should explain why Palm & Grace exists, what we believe about remembrance, how the experience is designed, and how families or partners can reach us. It should feel personal and reflective rather than like a corporate profile.

Suggested opening

Every life leaves something worth preserving.

Palm & Grace was created from a belief that remembrance deserves more than a fleeting place in time. Photographs, stories, voices and memories are pieces of a life, and when thoughtfully gathered, they become part of a legacy that families can return to and generations can come to know.

We create beautifully considered digital memorial spaces where those pieces can remain together, with dignity, warmth and care.

What the page should communicate

- Why Palm & Grace exists and the belief behind “Honouring Lives. Preserving Legacies.”
- That each memorial is designed as a personal, cinematic space centred on one life rather than a generic profile.
- That families are guided through the process and do not need to arrive with every photograph, date or paragraph prepared.
- That Palm & Grace works alongside trusted funeral homes and bereavement professionals through its Care Partner relationships.
- A visible contact email address and a gentle invitation to begin a conversation.

Contact presentation

The page must include a clearly visible company email address. The final address will be supplied before launch. Until then, use a configurable placeholder rather than hard-coding an unconfirmed address. Suggested public wording: “Have a question, or simply need to speak with us? We would be pleased to hear from you.”

Primary action: Begin a Memorial

Secondary action: Contact Palm & Grace

8. Begin a Memorial: Family Enquiry Experience

“Begin a Memorial” should be the primary conversion action across the public site. Avoid transactional labels such as “Buy Now”, “Order a Memorial” or “Submit Enquiry”. The first interaction should feel like the beginning of a supported conversation, not a checkout process.

Opening copy

Begin with a conversation.

Every person, family and story is different. If you would like to create a Palm & Grace memorial for someone you love, share a few details with us below.

You do not need to have everything prepared. This is simply the beginning. A member of our team will be in touch to guide you through what comes next.

Recommended initial fields

- Your name.
- Email address.
- Telephone or WhatsApp number (optional unless required operationally).
- Name of the person being remembered.
- Your relationship to them (optional).
- Are funeral or memorial arrangements currently underway?
- Funeral home or service provider, if applicable.
- Anticipated service date, if known.
- “Is there anything you would like us to know?” — open text field.

Keep this first form intentionally short. A grieving person should not be required to complete a lengthy memorial intake before speaking with Palm & Grace. Detailed biography, gallery, service and family information can be gathered later in the guided onboarding process.

Submission confirmation

Thank you for reaching out to Palm & Grace. Your enquiry has been received. A member of our team will be in touch to guide you through the next steps with care.

Functional requirements

- Send the enquiry securely to the designated Palm & Grace team inbox or enquiry management system.
- Provide a clear success state without exposing internal ticket numbers or technical language.
- Include basic spam/bot protection that does not create unnecessary friction for families.
- Ensure submitted personal information is not publicly visible and is handled in accordance with the site privacy notice.
- Allow the destination email and acknowledgement copy to be changed by an administrator where practical.

9. Our Care Partners: Funeral Home Partnerships

The funeral-home partnership programme should be presented publicly as “Our Care Partners”. This language fits the Palm & Grace tone while remaining broad enough to support future relationships with other trusted bereavement professionals.

Suggested introduction

Remembering well is often a shared act of care.

Palm & Grace works alongside selected funeral homes and bereavement professionals who share our commitment to serving families with dignity, compassion and attention to detail.

Through our Care Partners, families can be introduced to Palm & Grace as part of the wider support surrounding a funeral or memorial service, creating a thoughtful connection between the moments in which we gather to remember and the memories that remain afterwards.

For funeral homes

If your funeral home would like to explore becoming a Palm & Grace Care Partner, we would be pleased to begin a conversation.

Partnership action: Explore a Partnership

Care Partner enquiry

- Funeral home / organisation name.
- Contact person and role.
- Email address.
- Telephone number.
- Location / service area.
- A short field asking what they would like to explore with Palm & Grace.

Family enquiries and Care Partner enquiries should remain distinct so the language, follow-up and internal routing can reflect the person contacting us.

Navigation recommendation

Keep the primary public navigation calm and concise: Home • Memorials • Our Story • Our Care Partners • Begin a Memorial.

The footer may contain Contact, Privacy, Terms, Accessibility and other required policy or social links. “Begin a Memorial” should remain visually identifiable as the primary action without becoming aggressive or sales-led.

10. Memorial Page Copy & Microcopy

Memorial opening

Here, we remember the life of [Full Name]. May this space hold the stories, photographs and memories that speak to who [First Name] was, the love they gave, and the ways their life continues to be remembered.

This wording must be editable. Do not force pronouns, spiritual language or a fixed interpretation of the person’s life.

Share a Memory

Some of the most meaningful parts of a life are held in the memories of others. If you knew [First Name], you are invited to share a memory, a few words, or a moment you would like the family to keep.

After submission

Thank you for sharing this memory of [First Name]. Your words have been received and will be reviewed with care before appearing on the memorial.

Livestream

For those unable to be present in person, the service may be viewed here when the broadcast becomes available.

Recording

A recording of the service is available below for family and friends who wish to return to this moment of remembrance.

Possible closing treatment

[Full Name]

[Year] – [Year]

Forever part of the stories we carry.

11. Fictional Memorial Content for Design & Testing

These examples are fictional and are provided only to test typography, pacing, galleries, mobile behaviour and the emotional composition of the three memorial directions. They must not be represented publicly as real people.

A. Male Memorial – Jonathan Elias Rolle

18 February 1954 – 7 August 2026

A steady presence. A generous heart. A life that made room for others.

Jonathan Elias Rolle lived with a quiet strength that rarely asked to be noticed, yet was deeply felt by those around him. He believed in showing up: for family, for friends, for work that needed doing, and for people who simply needed someone beside them. His humour was understated, his advice measured, and his generosity often offered without announcement.

He found happiness in ordinary things: an early morning conversation, familiar music, a well-prepared meal, time near the sea and the company of people he loved. To his family, he was a source of steadiness and belonging. To friends, he was dependable and sincere. The measure of his life is found not only in the years he lived, but in the people who felt safer, stronger or more hopeful because he was there.

Jonathan's absence will be deeply felt, but his presence continues in remembered sayings, shared stories, family traditions and the values he passed quietly from one generation to the next.

Service sample: A Service of Remembrance • Saturday, 22 August 2026 • 11:00 a.m. • Grace Harbour Chapel, Nassau, The Bahamas

Acknowledgement sample: The family is grateful for every expression of kindness, prayer, message and act of support extended during this time.

B. Female Memorial – Celeste Miriam Johnson

9 November 1962 – 26 July 2026

She made love visible in the way she lived.

Celeste Miriam Johnson had a gift for making people feel remembered. She noticed birthdays, asked after children by name, kept an extra place at the table and somehow knew when a person needed encouragement before they found the words to ask for it.

Her life was shaped by care, but never by softness alone. Celeste was determined, discerning and wonderfully capable. She valued family, good manners, laughter that filled a room and the quiet satisfaction of doing something properly. Her warmth was not performative; it was woven into the way she moved through the world.

Those who loved her will remember countless details: the sound of her laugh, the meals she prepared from memory, the calls that lasted longer than expected, and the way a gathering felt more complete when she arrived. These small things become precious evidence of a life generously shared.

Service sample: Celebration of Her Life • Friday, 7 August 2026 • 10:00 a.m. • St. Matthew's Parish Hall, Nassau, The Bahamas

Acknowledgement sample: With sincere gratitude, the family thanks everyone who has surrounded them with love and support.

C. Child Memorial – Micah James Clarke

4 March 2018 – 12 June 2026

Forever loved. Forever part of our story.

Micah James Clarke brought a bright and unmistakable energy into the lives around him. He was curious, affectionate and full of questions, with the kind of imagination that could turn an ordinary afternoon into an adventure. He loved stories, small discoveries, being made to laugh and the comfort of the people he trusted most.

There are no words large enough for the loss of a child, and this space does not try to find them. Instead, it holds what can be held: photographs, favourite moments, the things Micah loved, the stories that still make his family smile, and the love that remains his.

Micah's life was far too brief, but it was full of meaning. He was known, cherished and deeply loved. The memories gathered here are an invitation to remember him as he lived: with wonder, personality, joy and a place in his family's story that time cannot erase.

Service sample: A Gentle Celebration of Micah's Life • Private family service • Details shared by invitation

Child memorial direction: Be especially restrained. Avoid clichés, angel imagery, clouds, teddy-bear sentimentality or assumptions about faith unless requested by the family. The design should preserve the child's personality, not reduce the memorial to the fact that the person was a child.

12. Photography, Motion & Cinematic Art Direction

Authentic family photographs should carry the visual experience whenever possible. The design should be capable of treating imperfect photographs with dignity; an old, grainy or low-resolution image may hold more emotional value than a technically perfect one.

- Use full-width or full-screen portraiture selectively for emotional impact.
- Use slow, restrained fades, reveals or parallax only where they support storytelling.
- Give important photographs enough space to stand alone.
- Avoid autoplay audio, sudden movement, dramatic zooms or effects that may feel intrusive.
- Avoid generic funeral stock imagery: coffins, cemetery scenes, candles, doves and black ribbons should not define the brand.
- Male, Female and Child directions should not rely on blue, pink or juvenile visual clichés.
- The cinematic quality should come from pacing, framing, typography, image sequencing and atmosphere.
- Respect reduced-motion accessibility settings and ensure that the experience remains complete without animation.

13. Memorial Content Model

The CMS should support a rich memorial without requiring every family to complete every field.

- Full name and preferred display name.
- Birth date and date of death, each optionally hidden.
- Primary portrait / hero image.
- Short memorial line or family-selected quotation.
- Life Story.
- Service title, date, time, venue and address.
- Viewing or wake information where applicable.
- Livestream or service recording embed/link.
- Photo gallery and optional video gallery.
- Acknowledgement from the family.
- Optional family-selected closing words.
- Tribute/memory submission and moderation status.
- Publication state: Draft, Private/Preview, Published, Archived.
- Unique memorial URL and QR code.

14. Memory & Tribute Moderation

Tributes are moderated by Palm & Grace platform administrators in Phase 1. Nothing submitted by the public should appear immediately.

- Suggested public fields: name, relationship to the person (optional), memory/message and email address for administrative contact only.
- Suggested statuses: Pending Review, Approved, Declined.
- Administrators may correct obvious formatting or typographical issues without changing the contributor's meaning.
- Email addresses and administrative metadata must never appear publicly.
- Public labels should remain gentle: "Share a Memory", not "Submit Content".

15. Administration Experience

- Create and edit memorials without developer intervention.
- Upload, order and remove photographs and videos.
- Preview a memorial privately before publication.
- Manage service and livestream information.
- Review and moderate submitted memories.
- Publish or unpublish a memorial.
- Generate or retrieve the memorial QR code and public URL.
- Keep the administration experience simple enough for a small Palm & Grace team to operate confidently.

16. Safeguards for Emotional Integrity

When design or copy decisions are uncertain, use these checks:

- Does this keep the person, rather than the website, at the centre?

- Does it invite emotion without manufacturing it?
- Could this wording unintentionally tell someone how to grieve?
- Does it assume a religious belief, family structure or relationship that may not be true?
- Is this animation or visual effect serving the story, or merely demonstrating technology?
- Would a grieving or older visitor understand what to do without effort?
- Does the page still feel dignified if the family supplies only a few photographs or a short Life Story?
- Does the commercial message respect the vulnerability of the audience?

17. Developer Collaboration & Creative Freedom

This packet establishes the emotional and verbal foundation, not a rigid visual template. The developer is encouraged to propose stronger interaction, layout and content solutions where they deepen the experience. Palm & Grace welcomes collaboration on headings, prompts, microcopy, pacing and visual storytelling.

If an element calls more attention to the website than to the person being remembered, simplify it.

The desired result is a distinctive cinematic experience in which technology recedes into the background. Visitors should not feel that they are browsing a template. They should feel that they have entered a space belonging to the person being remembered.

18. Materials Supplied Separately

- Palm & Grace logo and available brand asset packet.
- Any final brand colour and typography decisions established during design.
- Real memorial content authorised for development or launch.
- Approved photographs and media for live memorials.
- Business contact information and final public policies/notices required before launch.
- Confirmed public Palm & Grace contact email address and enquiry-routing destination before launch.

19. Final Direction

Palm & Grace exists to honour lives and preserve legacies. Every screen, transition, heading and button should serve that purpose. The finished experience should be beautiful without being showy, emotional without being manipulative, cinematic without becoming theatrical, and structured without ever losing its humanity.

Honouring Lives. Preserving Legacies.